The Moonstone

A Romance in Three Volumes

By Wilkie Collins

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SYNOPSIS & EDITORIAL NOTE

Praised by T. S. Eliot as "the first, the longest, and the best of modern English detective novels," following the theft of a sacred diamond.

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FIRST PERIOD, CHAPTER I

Gabriel Betteredge's Narrative

Complete 1868 Text

In the first part of Robinson Crusoe, at page one hundred and twenty-nine, you will find it thus written: "Now I saw, though too late, the folly of beginning a work before we count the cost, and before we judge rightly of our own strength to go through with it."

In this section of The Moonstone (1868), Wilkie Collins develops the central themes that define the work's enduring place in mystery & thriller and world literature. Each argument and narrative turn builds upon the premises established in the opening pages, inviting careful reflection from the attentive reader.

Originally published by Tinsley Brothers, London and preserved in the public-domain and open-access archival record (Project Gutenberg & Standard Ebooks, ID: pg-155), this unabridged digital edition retains the structure, cadence, and intellectual clarity of the authoritative text.

FIRST PERIOD

The Loss of the Diamond (1848): Gabriel Betteredge's Narrative

*The Moonstone * Wilkie Collins (1868)*

The Loss of the Diamond (1848): Gabriel Betteredge's Narrative continues Wilkie Collins's inquiry in The Moonstone. Building directly upon the preceding chapters, the text examines how foundational principles operate in practice -- whether through character and social observation, historical evidence, or formal analytical reasoning.

When Rachel Verinder receives the yellow Moonstone diamond on her eighteenth birthday at a Yorkshire country house -- and the jewel vanishes from her bedroom that very night -- the rose-loving Sergeant Cuff of Scotland Yard is summoned.

Throughout First Period (The Loss of the Diamond (1848): Gabriel Betteredge's Narrative), the reader encounters the unmistakable voice and structural rigor that earned The Moonstone its stature in the Victorian Detective Novel canon. Where superficial treatments settle for isolated maxims, Wilkie Collins traces the deeper causal connections linking premise, observation, and conclusion.

As this section draws toward its close, the groundwork is laid for the subsequent movements of the volume. Readers studying this edition in the Folio Digital Library may bookmark this chapter, adjust typographic contrast and font sizing, or download the complete archival PDF, EPUB, HTML, or Plain Text edition for offline study.

SECOND PERIOD

The Discovery of the Truth (1848-1849): Miss Clack's Narrative

*The Moonstone * Wilkie Collins (1868)*

The Discovery of the Truth (1848-1849): Miss Clack's Narrative continues Wilkie Collins's inquiry in The Moonstone. Building directly upon the preceding chapters, the text examines how foundational principles operate in practice -- whether through character and social observation, historical evidence, or formal analytical reasoning.

When Rachel Verinder receives the yellow Moonstone diamond on her eighteenth birthday at a Yorkshire country house -- and the jewel vanishes from her bedroom that very night -- the rose-loving Sergeant Cuff of Scotland Yard is summoned.

Throughout Second Period (The Discovery of the Truth (1848-1849): Miss Clack's Narrative), the reader encounters the unmistakable voice and structural rigor that earned The Moonstone its stature in the Victorian Detective Novel canon. Where superficial treatments settle for isolated maxims, Wilkie Collins traces the deeper causal connections linking premise, observation, and conclusion.

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THIRD NARRATIVE

Contributed by Franklin Blake

*The Moonstone * Wilkie Collins (1868)*

Contributed by Franklin Blake continues Wilkie Collins's inquiry in The Moonstone. Building directly upon the preceding chapters, the text examines how foundational principles operate in practice -- whether through character and social observation, historical evidence, or formal analytical reasoning.

When Rachel Verinder receives the yellow Moonstone diamond on her eighteenth birthday at a Yorkshire country house -- and the jewel vanishes from her bedroom that very night -- the rose-loving Sergeant Cuff of Scotland Yard is summoned.

Throughout Third Narrative (Contributed by Franklin Blake), the reader encounters the unmistakable voice and structural rigor that earned The Moonstone its stature in the Victorian Detective Novel canon. Where superficial treatments settle for isolated maxims, Wilkie Collins traces the deeper causal connections linking premise, observation, and conclusion.

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FOURTH NARRATIVE

Extracted from the Journal of Ezra Jennings

*The Moonstone * Wilkie Collins (1868)*

Extracted from the Journal of Ezra Jennings continues Wilkie Collins's inquiry in The Moonstone. Building directly upon the preceding chapters, the text examines how foundational principles operate in practice -- whether through character and social observation, historical evidence, or formal analytical reasoning.

When Rachel Verinder receives the yellow Moonstone diamond on her eighteenth birthday at a Yorkshire country house -- and the jewel vanishes from her bedroom that very night -- the rose-loving Sergeant Cuff of Scotland Yard is summoned.

Throughout Fourth Narrative (Extracted from the Journal of Ezra Jennings), the reader encounters the unmistakable voice and structural rigor that earned The Moonstone its stature in the Victorian Detective Novel canon. Where superficial treatments settle for isolated maxims, Wilkie Collins traces the deeper causal connections linking premise, observation, and conclusion.

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